



Fotios Pongas

DevOps & Cloud Computing Engineer

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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud

AWS (EC2, S3, EKS, Lambda, VPC, IAM), Azure (AKS, Blob, AI Search, OpenAI, Monitor)

Containers

Docker, Kubernetes

CI/CD

Git, GitHub Actions

laC

Terraform (AWS & Azure)

Monitoring

Prometheus, Grafana, Loki

OS & Scripting

Linux, Bash, Python

Networking

DNS, Load Balancing, Firewalls, VPC

Web

NGINX, containerised apps

SOFT SKILLS

- Incident response
- Cross-team coordination
- Leadership
- Calm under pressure
- Clear communication
- Multilingual
- Adaptability

LANGUAGES

Greek

English (C2)

German (A2)

CERTIFICATIONS

DevOps & Cloud Programme

Ironhack | 09/2025 – 03/2026

Intensive programme covering cloud infrastructure, CI/CD, IaC and monitoring on AWS and Azure.

AWS Cloud Practitioner

Amazon Web Services | 07/2025

Foundational certification validating cloud concepts, core services, security and billing.

Stepping into Management

Advanced

04/2009 – 10/2009

Advanced leadership and team management for senior operational roles.

Communication & HR

Management

01/2015 – 02/2015

Workplace communication, conflict resolution and HR fundamentals for managers.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Award-Winning DevOps & Cloud Engineer (Ironhack Hackshow 2026 Winner) with 25 years of experience in high-stakes Operations and Leadership. Expert at bridging the gap between infrastructure automation and business reliability, with hands-on proficiency in AWS, Azure, Kubernetes, and Terraform. Specialist in Incident Response and Operational Resilience, I bring a unique "Ops-first" mindset from managing 5-star hotel operations and multi-national teams under 24/7 pressure. Proven ability to architect scalable cloud solutions and automate CI/CD pipelines, recognized for technical excellence and leadership. Seeking to deliver 5-star stability to a forward-thinking DevOps or SRE team.

DEVOPS PROJECTS

Expensy — Full-Stack App on Kubernetes & Azure AKS

Jan – Mar 2026

github.com/Kabamaru2372/max.devops.expensy

- Built to demonstrate end-to-end deployment of a full-stack application across local and production environments using container orchestration.
- Provisioned Azure AKS with Kubernetes manifests, secrets management, NGINX Ingress and a GitHub Actions CI/CD pipeline with Prometheus & Grafana monitoring.
- Tools: Node.js, Next.js, Docker, Kubernetes, Azure AKS, MongoDB, Redis, Terraform, GitHub Actions, Prometheus, Grafana.

Hotel Knowledge Assistant — RAG Pipeline on Azure

Feb – Mar 2026

github.com/Kabamaru2372/hotel-training-RAG-pipeline

- Winner of the DevOps category at Ironhack Hackshow April 2026, selected by a panel of instructors and industry judges across cohorts.
- Built to enable hotel teams to query internal training documents via a conversational AI interface; owned full infrastructure, provisioning Azure resources with Terraform, containerising with Docker and deploying to Azure Container Apps via GitHub Actions.
- Tools: Azure Blob Storage, Azure AI Search, Azure OpenAI (GPT-4o-mini), FastAPI, Docker, Terraform, GitHub Actions.

Professional Portfolio · fotiospongas.dev

Mar 2026

github.com/Kabamaru2372/fotios.website

- Built to establish a professional online presence and demonstrate full ownership of the development and deployment lifecycle.
- Deployed via GitHub Actions CI/CD with custom domain, complete end-to-end ownership from code to production.
- Tools: React, Vite, GitHub Actions, custom DNS.

AWARDS

Ironhack Hackshow — DevOps Category Winner

April 2026

Awarded for the Hotel Knowledge Assistant project at Ironhack's first remote Hackshow of 2026. Selected across the DevOps & Cloud cohort for technical execution, real-world applicability and end-to-end ownership of cloud infrastructure.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Operations & Retail Management

01/1999 – 10/2023

Various 4* & 5* Hotels (incl. Sheraton) / Dixons (Kotsovolos) — Rhodes, Greece

- Led front office operations serving a high volume of daily guests, maintaining 95%+ guest satisfaction through optimised workflow coordination.
- Managed cross-department scheduling, incident resolution and 24/7 operational continuity; directly transferable to on-call DevOps practices.
- Trained and coordinated multi-national teams of up to 24 people under high-pressure environments.
- Drove consistent sales growth through performance coaching and optimised floor management across retail operations.

RECOMMENDATION

"Fotios consistently demonstrated strong resilience, motivation and a genuine commitment to learning. He successfully completed the programme and showed significant progress. The effort and dedication he invested in his final project are a clear reflection of his character and his determination to succeed in this field. Fotios is a continuous learner with the right mindset, both technically and personally. I highly recommend him and am confident he will be a valuable asset to any team."

Yacine Hamdada

Lead Instructor, Ironhack DevOps & Cloud Programme